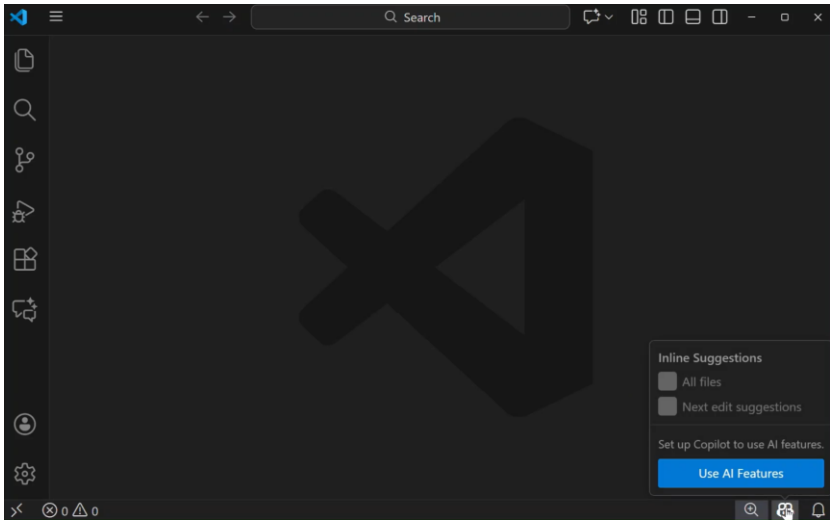
VS Code GitHub Copilot instructions

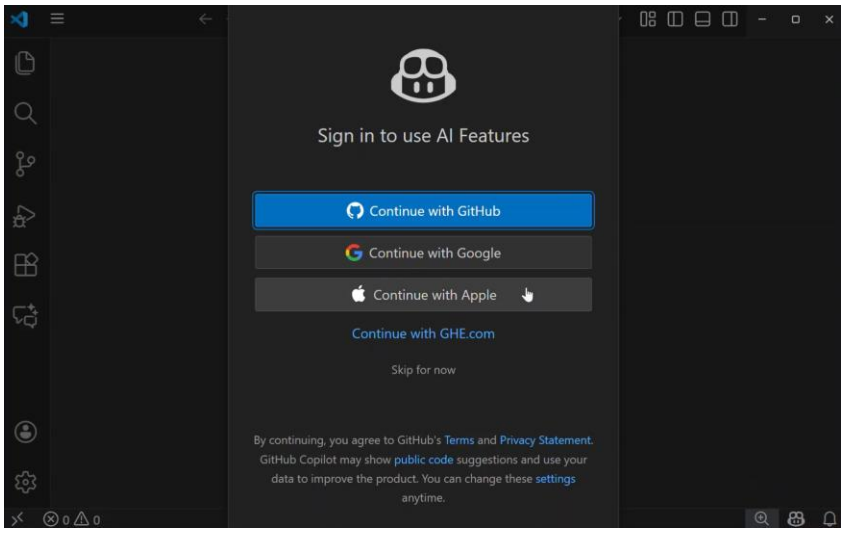
Full detailed instructions available here.

Enabling GitHub Copilot in VS Code:

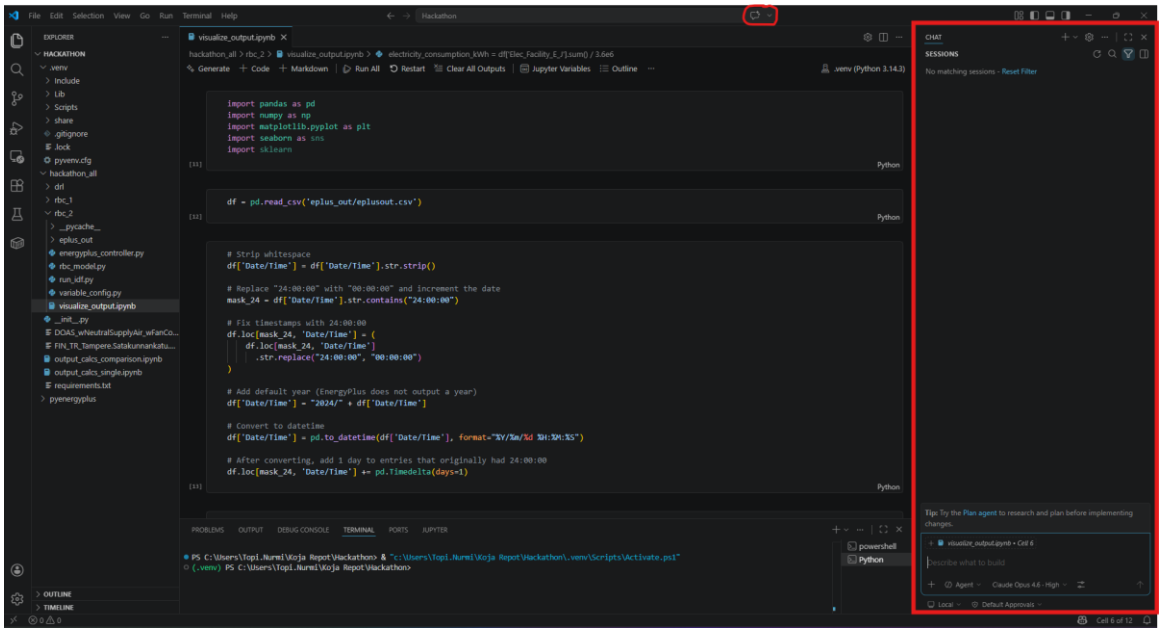
Hover over the GitHub Copilot icon in the bottom right corner of the VS Code window. Select Use AI Features.



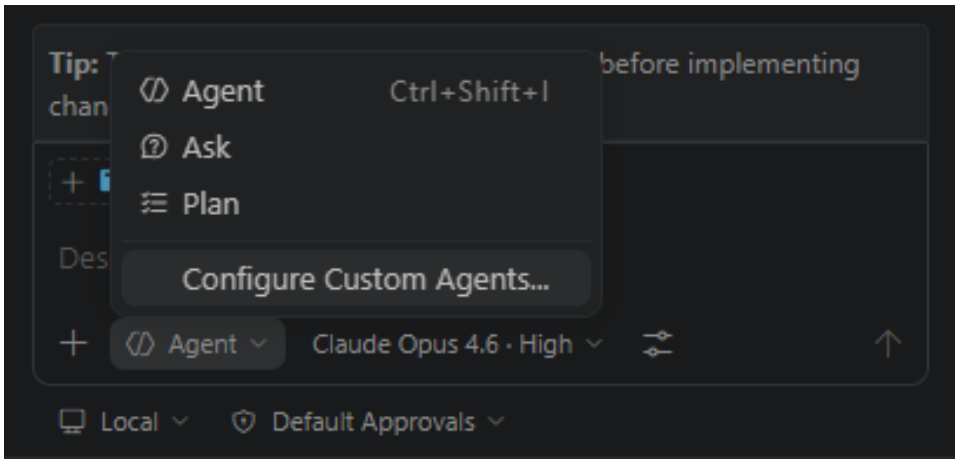
Log in to your GitHub account using the sign in method of your choice.



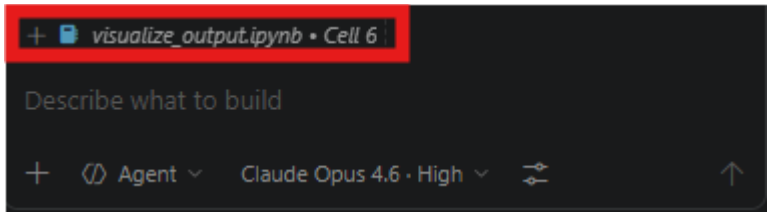
After logging in you can open the chat window by clicking the icon at the top of your VS Code window. The chat should open on the right side of VS Code.



You can choose the operating mode of the AI agent in the chat. Agent-mode can edit files in the workspace, Ask-mode answers questions and instructs without editing the code, and Plan-mode outlines multi-step plans.

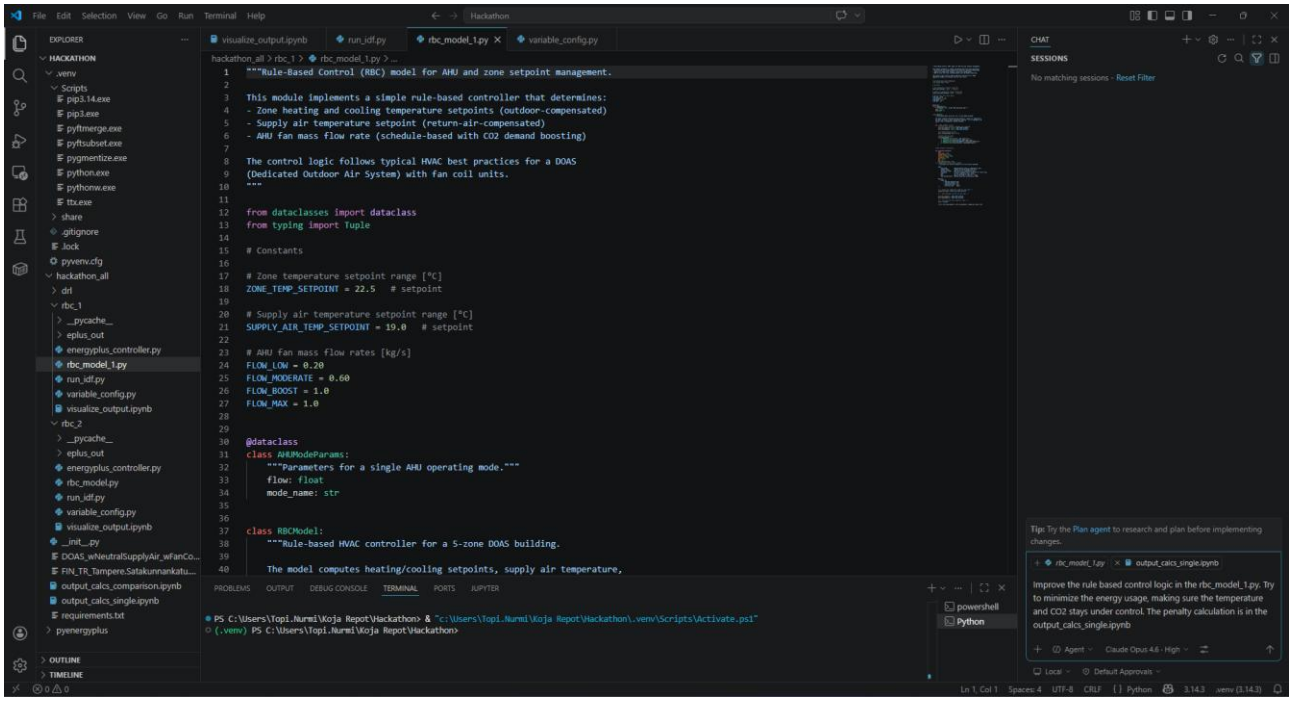


At the top of the chat textbox, you can choose what files the AI agent has for context. The focused file in VS Code is always selected for context, but more files can be added by pressing the plus sign. The AI agent has visibility to all the files in the workspace.

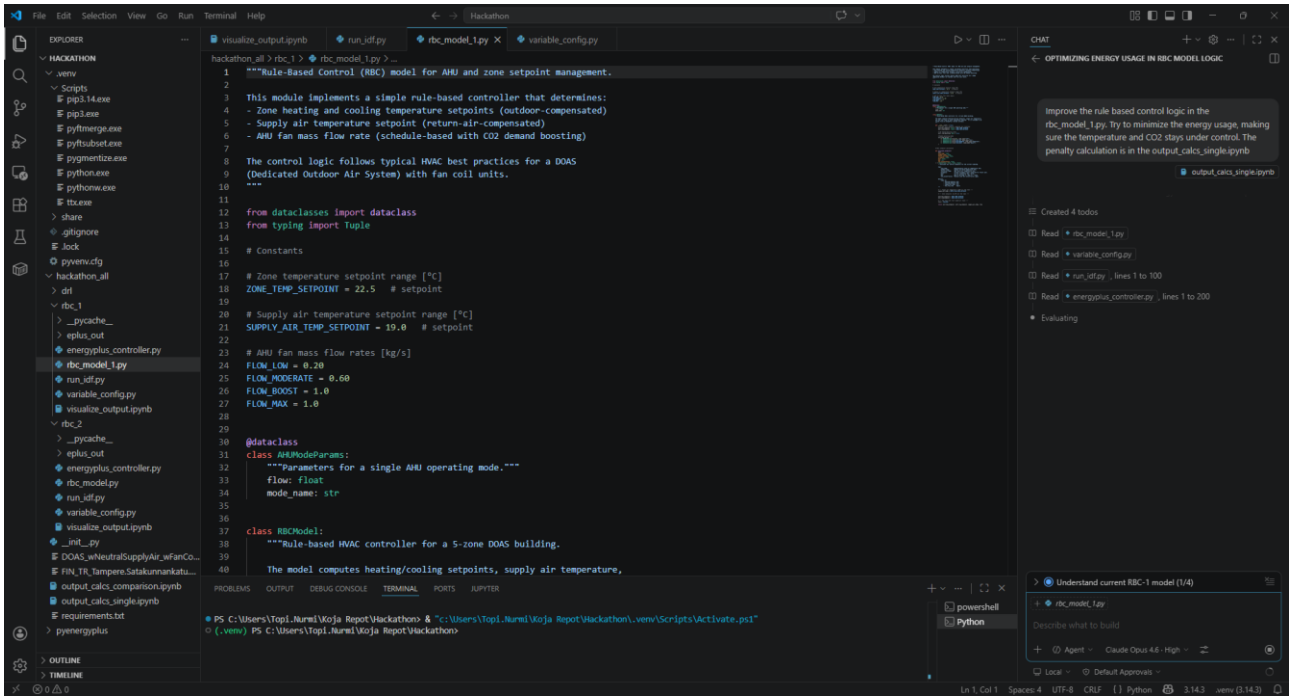


Example use

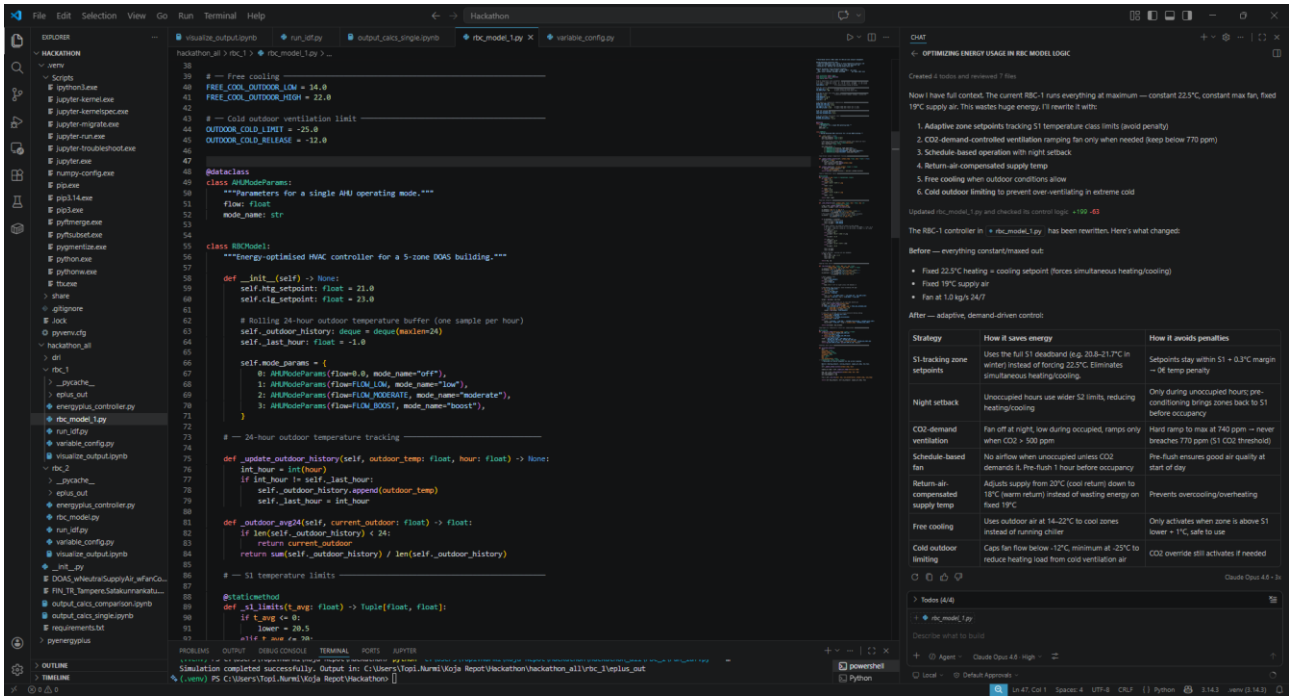
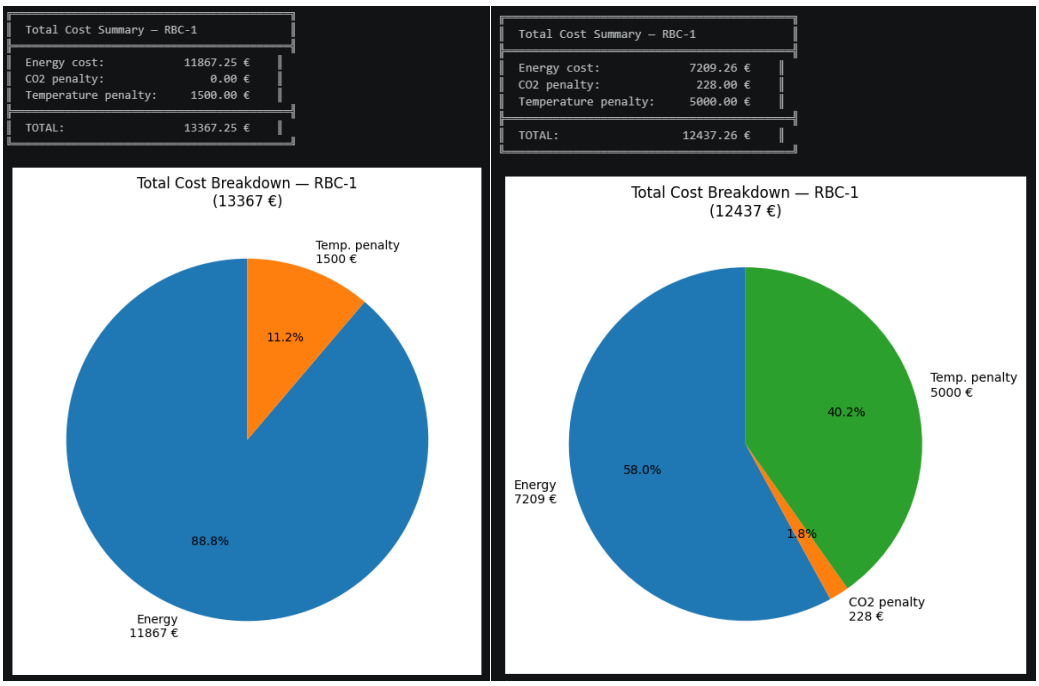
The simple rule-based control model (rbc_model.py) and the penalty calculation jupyter notebook (output_calcs_single.ipynb) are added to the AI context. Instructions are written into the chat textbox.



The prompt is run and the AI starts processing the request.



The AI agent suggested changes to the rbc_model_1.py and the changes were accepted by the user. The run_idf.py is ran to simulate the environment with the new control and the output_calcs are calculated to update the cost breakdown.



Before the changes the cost was 13 367€ and after the changes 12 437€. The cost of energy is drastically reduced, but the changed control model got more penalties.